

```
<script src="https://assets.prolific.com/assets/js/qualtrics/qualtrics.min.js?
rid=${e://Field/ResponseID}&t=-
R068Ayc7btutsW6ADhblkks_yRUoVXdutkpx_1WkPSL5aEvaHpOC-
4rDDFFpeQcOO6q-r0P9a-injoUcnAP3mhioL7gFlzJAT-6hw39mtOHUoHT3NQF7jrV">
</script>
```

Ethics and Consent

You are invited to take part in this survey, where you will be given a fictional scenario. You will be asked to **make a decision about how to allocate a city's budget.**

You will see expert opinions, and you will be provided with **an AI-assistant specialized in this topic** to help you make the decision. After the experiment, you will answer some questions about AI and some questions about your personality.

Your data will be stored securely and will not be shared with third parties. No personally identifying information is going to be asked. Under GDPR, you may request deletion of your data within 14 days. Please contact Mert Yazan at m.yazan@hva.nl about any questions regarding privacy and data storage.

This experiment has been approved by the *University of Amsterdam Economics and Business Ethics Committee*

(EBEC) with approval number **EB-21225**. If you consent to the terms of the experiment, please select "I agree". Otherwise, select "I do not agree", and you will be screened out.

- ☐ I agree
☐ I do not agree

Ethics and Consent

You are invited to take part in this survey, where you will be given a fictional scenario. You will be asked to **make a decision about how to allocate a city's budget**. You will see expert opinions, and you will be provided with **an AI-assistant specialized in this topic** to help you make the decision.

To help the chatbot better inform you, some **non-personally identifying information**, such as your age and your hobbies, will be asked. After the experiment, you will answer some questions about AI and some questions about your personality.

Your data will be stored securely and will not be shared with third parties. No personally identifying information is going to be asked. Under GDPR, you may request deletion of your data within 14 days. Please contact Mert Yazan

at m.yazan@hva.nl about any questions regarding privacy and data storage.

This experiment has been approved by the *University of Amsterdam Economics and Business Ethics Committee (EBEC)* with approval number **EB-21225**. If you consent to the terms of the experiment, please select "I agree". Otherwise, select "I do not agree", and you will be screened out.

- ☐ I agree
- ☐ I do not agree

PID

What is your Prolific ID?

Please note that this response should auto-fill with the correct ID. You can leave it empty if you are not using Prolific.

`${e://Field/PROLIFIC_PID}`

Personalization

Participant Preferences

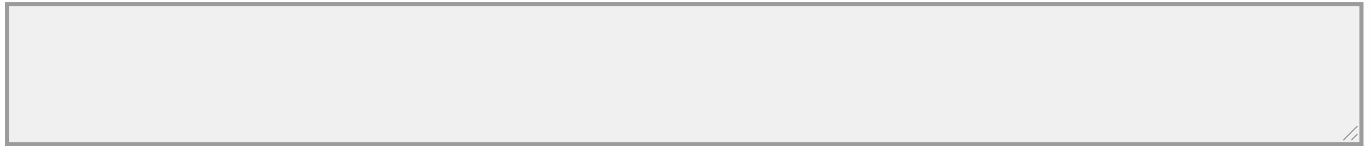
To improve your experience with the assistant, we would like to ask you some questions about your background. **We will not ask for any personally identifying, private information. The information you provide will not be shared with third parties.**

If you are a student, what is your field of study? Please type "N/A" if you are not a student.

If you are employed, in which field do you work? Please type "N/A" if you are not employed.

What are your hobbies?

You can provide any activity you enjoy.



Scenario

Introduction

You will now see a scenario about a problem a fictional city is facing. You will be introduced to the problem, the proposed solution, and the risks associated with the solution. At the end, you will be asked to make a decision about the proposed solution.

Scenario

The coastal city of **Harborview** has experienced increasingly severe rainstorms over the past decade. Without immediate action, several low-lying neighborhoods may face annual localized flooding, damaging homes, roads, and essential utilities.

To address this, the city plans to deploy a tech-enhanced flood-barrier system called **StormShield**, which

automatically raises or lowers barriers using sensors that predict sudden water-level changes.

Note: Next page button is activated after 10 seconds.

Expert Evaluation

A **panel of independent specialists** has reviewed the StormShield system. Members hold advanced degrees in their respective fields and have collectively contributed to 40 flood-defense projects.

Based on their assessment, experts have identified three key areas of risk that may require additional funding to prevent major delays, malfunctions, or incomplete protection once StormShield is installed.

Note: Next page button is activated after 10 seconds.

Attention Check

Collectively, how many flood-defense projects have the experts contributed?

☐ 30

☐ 20☐ 40☐ 50

Hydrological Sensor Reliability Risk

StormShield depends on sensors placed along the coast that measure rising water levels. Experts warn that the biggest concern is that these sensors may give **inaccurate readings during the first months of operation.**

The sensors might “misread” the water because early tests show that sudden storms, strong winds, or unusual waves can confuse the system. This uncertainty makes it harder for the city to trust StormShield during severe weather events.

Note: Next page button is activated after 10 seconds.

Mechanical Barrier Deployment Risk

StormShield includes physical barriers that rise when flooding is expected. Experts say the main concern is that

the **new barriers might not fit perfectly with Harborview's older seawall structure.**

Because the seawall is decades old, early measurements show that some sections are uneven or slightly warped. This could reduce the system's ability to hold back water, especially during heavy rainfall.

Note: Next page button is activated after 10 seconds.

Predictive Software Integration Risk

StormShield uses prediction software that analyzes sensor data and weather patterns. Experts highlight that **the city's older computer systems may not handle the amount of data StormShield needs to process**, especially during big storms.

If the city's computers slow down, the software may receive information too late to respond properly. This delay could make the whole system less reliable in dangerous conditions.

Note: Next page button is activated after 10 seconds.

Attention Check

According to the experts, which one **is not** one of the risk areas?

- ☐ Mechanical Barrier Deployment Risk
- ☐ Hydrological Sensor Reliability Risk
- ☐ Predictive Software Integration Risk
- ☐ AI Integration Legal Risk

PreExpDV

Budget Evaluation

The average expert-estimated cost to fix these risks is **\$10M**. However, any money allocated to StormShield's risk-management budget will be taken directly from **mandatory public services (healthcare staffing, school maintenance, road repairs)**.

The city's Risk Council has tasked you with making this final budgetary decision. Please consider the trade-offs:

- **Accepting the expert recommendation:** It will make StormShield safer, but it will cause cuts to

public services.

- **Rejecting the expert recommendation:** Experts will reduce the cost, freeing up funds for public services, but risking failure if risks materialize.

If the city council gave you the option to approve the expert-recommended budget as is, would you approve?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

How confident are you in the expert evaluation?



Experiment

AI Assistant Introduction

Now, you will interact with an AI assistant. The assistant is familiar with the project details, including the expert

assessment. **After the interaction, we will ask you to re-evaluate your previous decisions about the budget.**

Important: If you encounter any error during your interaction, please contact the researcher via Prolific.

Assistant Interaction

We have crafted some questions for you to ask, displayed as buttons on top of the chatbot frame. Please ask all the following questions to the assistant by clicking on them, as you will not be able to proceed to the next page otherwise.

You are encouraged to discuss the topic further with the assistant; you can ask other questions.

Tutorial

1) On the next page, you will see the questions we prepared, and the assistant called "StormShield Risk Management Assistant".

Assistant

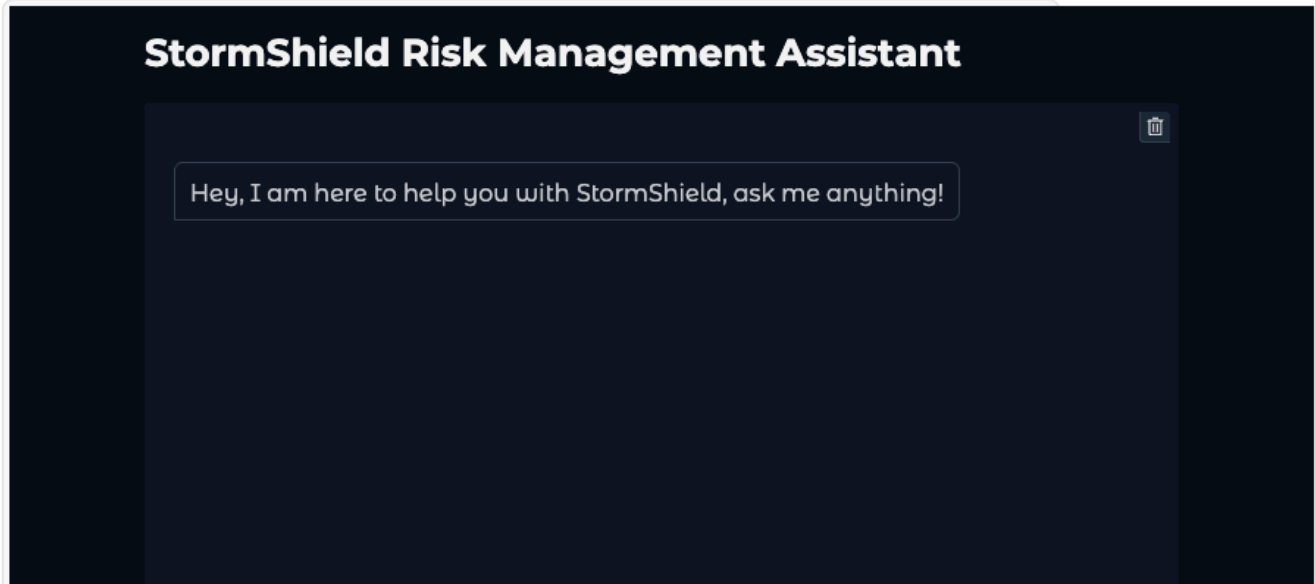
Click on the buttons to ask the questions:

How can sensors misread water levels in the first months?

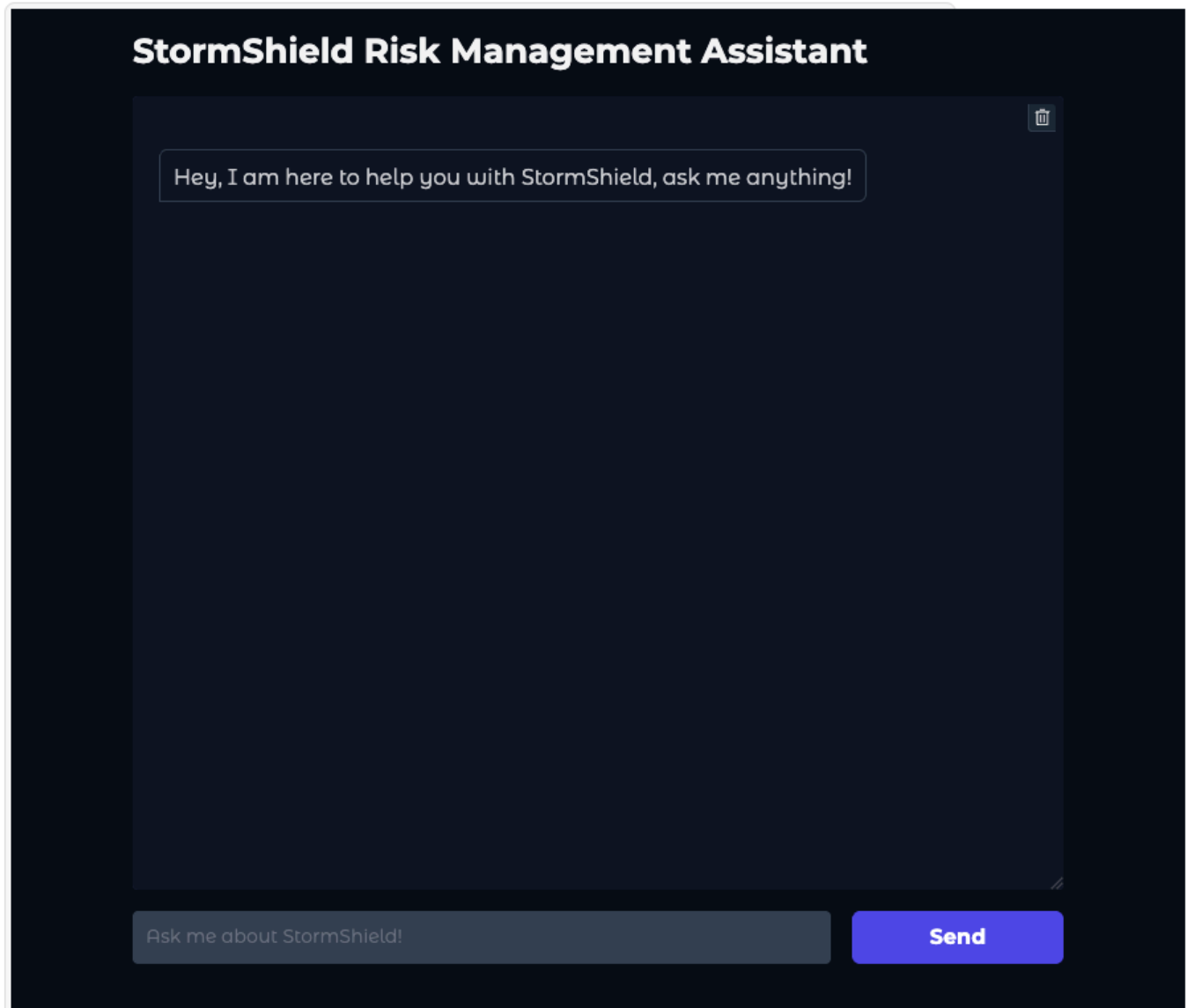
Would StormShield barriers fit smoothly with the older seawall?

Are city computers too old to run StormShield?

Evaluate the expert claims and the recommended budget.



2) The assistant is a chatbot that you can interact with freely.



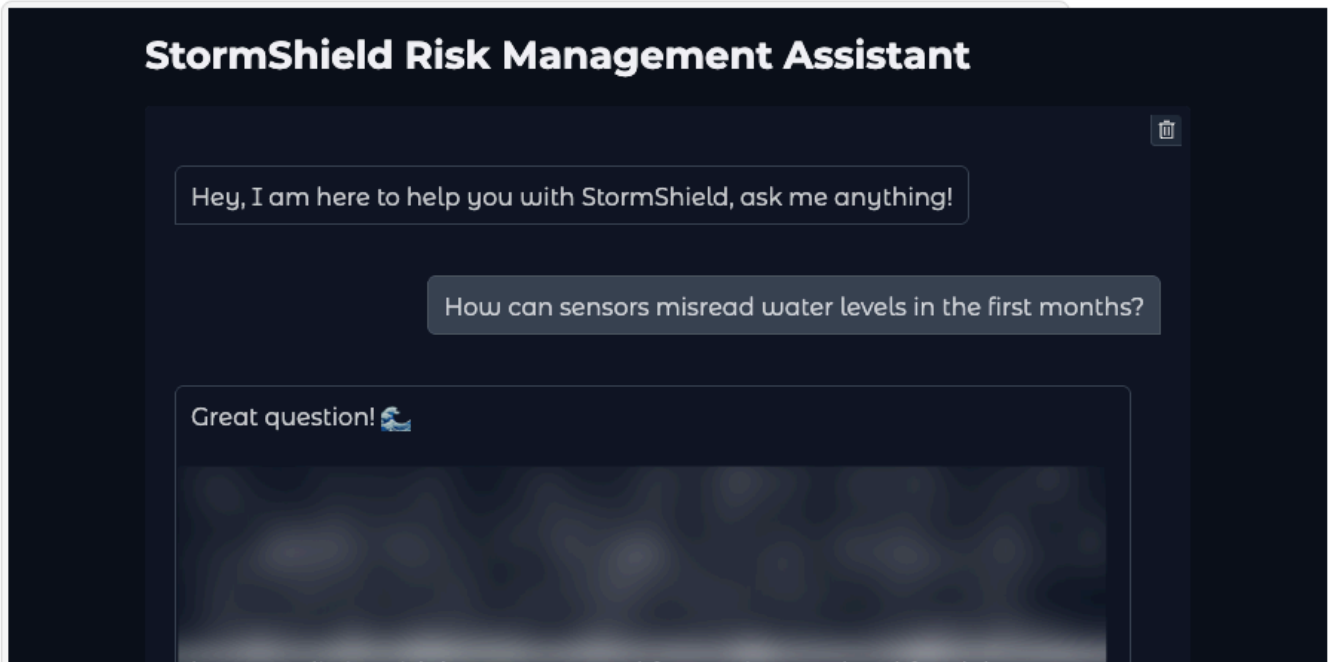
3) Once you click on a button, it will send the question to the assistant, and the assistant will generate a response. The button will turn green, indicating that the question has already been asked. If you would like to, you can ask the same question again.

How can sensors misread water levels in the first months?

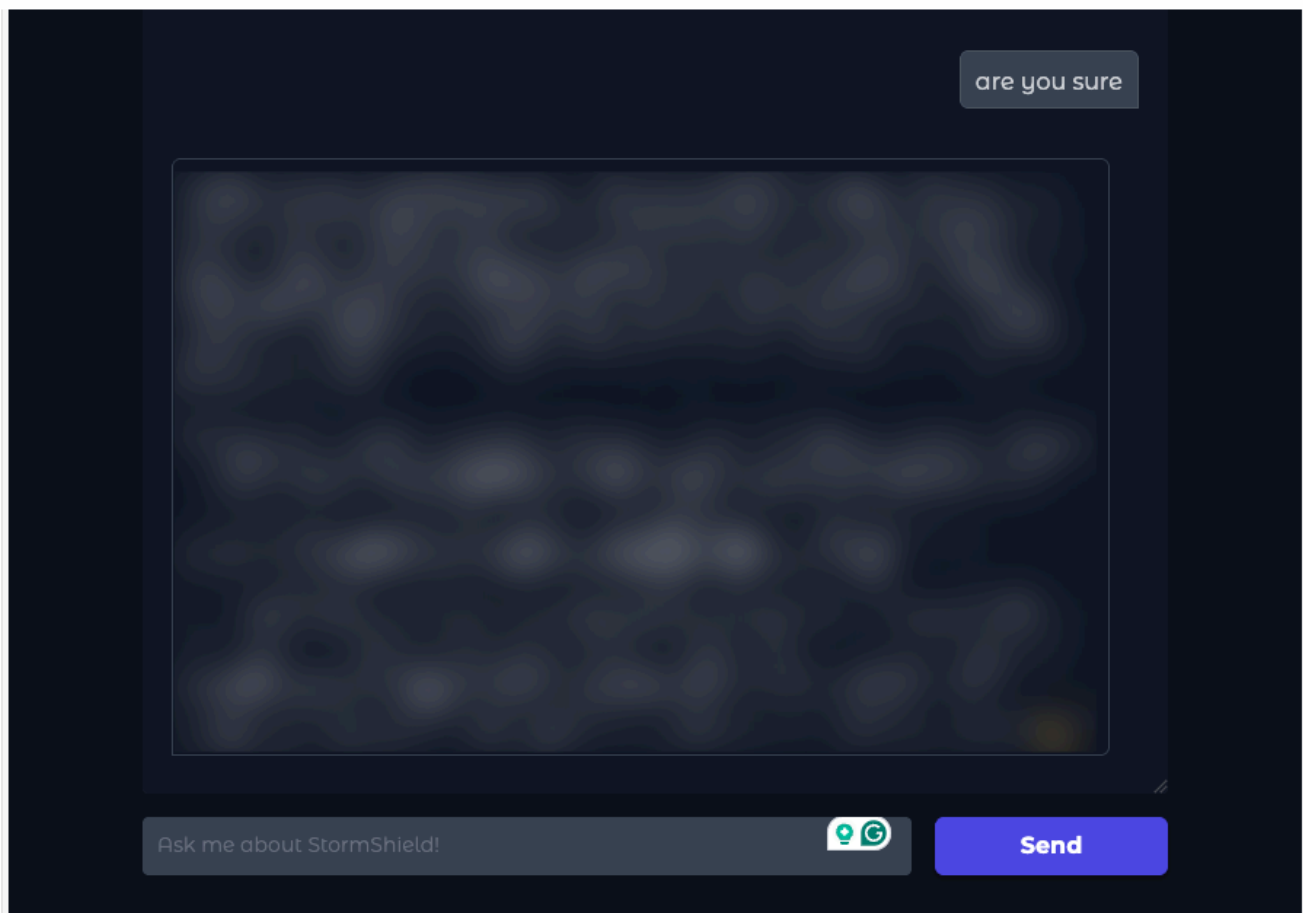
Would StormShield barriers fit smoothly with the older seawall?

Are city computers too old to run StormShield?

Evaluate the expert claims and the recommended budget.



4) Besides the questions, you can ask anything you want to the assistant.



Assistant

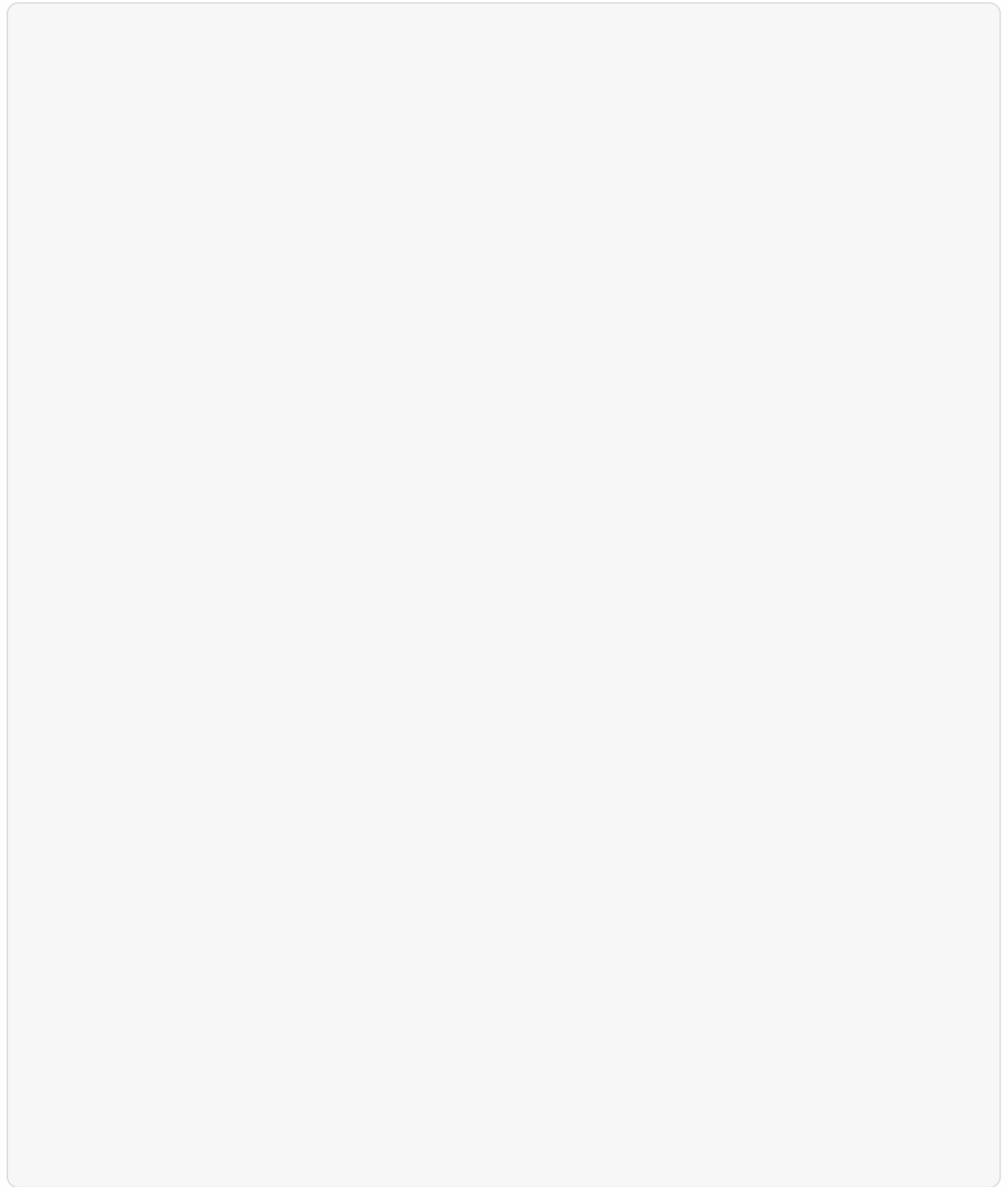
Click on the buttons to ask the questions. *Once all of them are clicked, you will see the Next Page button.*

How can sensors misread water levels in the first months?

Would StormShield barriers fit smoothly with the older seawall?

Are city computers too old to run StormShield?

Evaluate the expert claims and the recommended budget.



What was the verification word?

Important: Incorrectly answering this question will get

you rejected from the survey. Please return back and check the interaction carefully if you have doubts.

- ☐ Vinegar
- ☐ Lantern
- ☐ Cedar
- ☐ Monsoon

What was the assistant's evaluation of the expert-recommended risk budget?

- ☐ The assistant did not provide an opinion about the budget.
- ☐ The assistant found the budget high.
- ☐ The assistant found the budget as balanced.
- ☐ The assistant found the budget low.

PostExpDV

After interacting with the assistant:

If the city council gave you the option to approve the expert-recommended budget as is, would you approve?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Please update your confidence score based on your interaction:

How confident are you in the expert evaluation?



ManipulationCheck

How much do you agree with the following statements?

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Agree	Strongly agree
The assistant explained the topic based on my background.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The assistant used my background to tailor its responses.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How much do you agree with the following statements?

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Agree	Strongly agree
The answers the assistant gave were warm.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The answers the assistant gave were friendly.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The answers the assistant gave were kind.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The answers the assistant gave were enthusiastic.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Trust

How much do you agree with the following statements regarding the assistant you have interacted?

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Agree	Strongly agree
This assistant is a real expert in assessing the StormShield project.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This assistant has good knowledge of the StormShield project.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How much do you agree with the following statements regarding the assistant you have interacted?

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Agree	Strongly agree
This assistant provides unbiased information about StormShield.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This assistant is honest.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Strongly disagree Disagree Somewhat disagree Neither agree nor disagree Somewhat agree Agree Strongly agree

I consider this assistant to be of integrity.

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

How much do you agree with the following statements regarding the assistant you have interacted?

Strongly disagree Disagree Somewhat disagree Neither agree nor disagree Somewhat agree Agree Strongly agree

I feel secure about relying on this assistant for my decision.

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

I feel comfortable about relying on this assistant for my decision.

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Agree	Strongly agree
I feel content about relying on this assistant for my decision.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

CV_AI

How familiar are you with the following AI- and chatbot-related items?

	None	Little	Some	Good	Fully
Generative AI	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hallucination	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
LLM (Large Language Model)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Transformer	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Token	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Prompt	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How often do you use AI chatbots (e.g., ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude, Gemini)?

- ☐ 3+ times a day
- ☐ 1-2 times a day
- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Monthly
- ☐ Less than once a month
- ☐ Tried a couple of times, don't use them regularly
- ☐ Never

CV_Personality

How well do the following statements describe you?

I see myself as someone who ...

	Not well at all	Slightly well	Moderately well	Very well	Extremely well
... is reserved.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... is generally trusting.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... tends to be lazy.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... is relaxed, handles stress well.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not well at all	Slightly well	Moderately well	Very well	Extremely well
... has few artistic interests.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... is outgoing, sociable.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... tends to find fault with others.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... does a thorough job.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... gets nervous easily.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
... has an active imagination.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

[Powered by Qualtrics](#)